

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Four concepts card

DIVERSITY -> distinct linguistic, cultural, ecological and historical identities

REGIONALISM -> political assertion of a region's identity and interest

SUB-REGIONALISM -> assertion within an already-recognised state or region

DISPARITY -> unequal income, infrastructure, human development, fiscal capacity

MUST REMEMBER: Regionalism is political, economic or cultural mobilisation around territory and perceived interests; it can deepen federal representation and cultural recognition or become exclusionary when joined to unequal development, resource competition and insider-outsider politics.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Two independent axes

DISTINCT AND PROSPEROUS -> cultural difference without a development gap

DISTINCT AND LAGGING -> cultural difference with a development gap

SIMILAR AND LAGGING -> a development gap inside a culturally similar space

CONCLUSION -> the axes are independent, so the definitions must stay separate

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Demand decomposition

PART ONE -> define regional disparity as an outcome-based development gap

PART TWO -> distinguish it from diversity with a paired example

PART THREE -> assess seriousness with named indicator families

FAILURE MODE -> one blended paragraph that answers none of the three

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Driver and instrument

IDENTITY-DRIVEN -> seeks linguistic status, cultural autonomy, representation

RESPONSE -> recognition, not a development package

DISPARITY-DRIVEN -> seeks infrastructure, investment, fiscal transfer

RESPONSE -> redistribution, not a symbolic gesture

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Compounded case

INPUT -> distinct sub-regional identity within an existing state

ADDED -> perceived neglect in infrastructure and investment

ADDED -> under-representation in state-level political power

RULE -> compounding is possible, escalation is never automatic

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Movement forms

STATEHOOD -> a new unit within the Union

AUTONOMY -> greater self-governance inside an existing unit

SECESSION -> separation from the Union, the least common Indian form

PROHIBITION -> the three are not a compulsory escalation ladder

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Accommodation precedent

STATUTE -> States Reorganisation Act, 1956

BASIS -> restructuring substantially along linguistic lines

MEANING -> regionalism accommodated through recognition, not suppressed

LIMIT -> a precedent, not proof that reorganisation always succeeds

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Index card

SOURCE -> NITI Aayog SDG India Index, composite state and union territory ranking

EDITION -> 2023-24 is the most recently published as of July 2026

USE -> benchmarking of state-wise development outcomes

LIMIT -> aggregation hides a lagging sub-region inside a well-ranked state

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Seriousness assessment

INCOME -> per-capita and household outcome gaps between regions

INFRASTRUCTURE -> connectivity, power, water and service availability

HUMAN DEVELOPMENT -> education and health attainment

FISCAL CAPACITY -> the region's own capacity to fund its correction

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Cost of a new unit

GAIN -> a recognition grievance is answered by a new political boundary

RISK -> the new unit contains its own internal lagging sub-region

IMPLICATION -> reorganisation relocates rather than dissolves disparity

ANSWER USE -> pair the accommodation record with this internal cost

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Region is not state, regionalism is not automatically separatism, federal autonomy is not sovereignty, sub-state demand is not secession, and linguistic reorganisation, inter-state disputes, special provisions and local nativism have distinct constitutional routes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Cross-owner boundary

SOCIETY OWNS -> grievance, assertion, movement form and accommodation

GEOGRAPHY OWNS -> five-year-plan and regional-development policy mechanics

POLITY OWNS -> Centre-State fiscal transfer and federal doctrine

RULE -> cross-link the instrument, do not re-derive it

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Use Andhra, Maharashtra-Gujarat, Telangana, Gorkhaland, Bodoland, Northeast
autonomy and river/resource disputes with historical specificity; distinguish grievance,
leadership, mobilisation and outcome, and do not infer separatism from every regional party.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Regionalism answer spine

OPEN -> define diversity and disparity separately in the first two lines
BODY -> paired example, then indicator families for the seriousness verdict
TEST -> identity driver against development driver, then compounding
CLOSE -> diagnosis-matched response with the index limitation stated